

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Ripple Blanket Pattern for Beginners

A classic wave-stitch throw built from repeated peaks and valleys, ideal for using up leftover yarn in stripes.

Updated 2026 • US terms • About 36 x 48in / 91 x 122cm



The ripple, or chevron, stitch creates its signature wave shape from alternating increases and decreases spaced evenly across each row. Once you understand the placement of those points, the rest of the row is straightforward double crochet, the same stitch from our [granny square tutorial](#).

MATERIALS

- Worsted-weight yarn, roughly 1,200–1,500 yards total (one colour or striped)
- 5.5mm (US size I) crochet hook
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
dc	Double crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
dec	Dc 2 sts together (decrease)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.

 Crochet hook with yarn showing wave pattern structure

GAUGE

12 dc and 8 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 5.5mm hook and worsted yarn. This blanket is forgiving on exact size; adjust the starting chain length in multiples of 18 to make it wider or narrower.

NOTES

- Written in US terms, worked flat in rows using the same double crochet stitch as our [granny square tutorial](#).
- Change yarn colour at the start of any row for a striped ripple effect — a popular way to use up leftover yarn.

- This pattern's repeat is 18 stitches; the starting chain below makes a lap-sized throw with 4 full repeats across.

Pattern

FOUNDATION

Chain 74 (4 pattern repeats of 18, plus 2 extra for the edge).

ROW 1

Dc in the 3rd chain from hook. Dc in next 6 chains. Dec over next 2 chains. Dc in next 6 chains. [3 dc in next chain] (this forms the peak point). Repeat the sequence dc 6, dec, dc 6, 3-dc-in-1 across the row, ending with dc in the last 7 chains. Turn.

ROW 2 AND ALL FOLLOWING ROWS

Ch 3 (counts as first dc), skip first st. Dc in next 6 sts. Dec over next 2 sts. Dc in next 6 sts. [3 dc in next st] at each peak point. Repeat this sequence across the row, ending with dc in the last 7 sts. Turn.

Repeat this row until the blanket reaches your desired length, roughly 48in / 122cm for a lap throw.

FINISHING

Fasten off and weave in all ends with a yarn needle, including any colour-change joins if you striped the blanket.

Frequently asked questions

What causes the wave shape in a ripple crochet blanket?

The wave comes from alternating increases and decreases across each row, worked at set points rather than evenly, which pushes some sections up into peaks and pulls others down into valleys.

How much yarn do I need for a ripple blanket?

A lap-sized ripple throw uses roughly 1,200 to 1,500 yards of worsted-weight yarn, similar to a granny square blanket of the same size.

Is ripple crochet good for using up scrap yarn?

Yes, ripple patterns are a popular way to use up leftover yarn, since colour stripes can change at any row without affecting the wave structure, unlike patterns where colour changes need to align with specific stitches.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.